

TOPIC 8: LITERATURE – PROSE FEATURES & FIGURES OF SPEECH

1. Features of Prose

Prose is ordinary written language (novels, short stories, essays) as opposed to poetry. Key features:

- **Setting** – time and place of the story
- **Plot** – sequence of events (beginning, middle, end; conflict and resolution)
- **Characters** – people (or animals) in the story; characterisation is how the writer presents them
- **Theme** – central idea or message
- **Style** – the writer's way of using language
- **Point of view** – who narrates (first person, third person)

2. Types of Prose

Narrative (tells a story), Descriptive (describes), Fiction and Non-fiction. Folktales, myths and legends are traditional narrative forms with moral lessons, entertainment and sometimes magical elements.

3. Figures of Speech

- **Simile** – comparison using like or as (as brave as a lion)
- **Metaphor** – direct comparison (He is a lion in battle)
- **Personification** – giving human qualities to non-human things (The wind whispered)
- **Alliteration** – repetition of initial consonant sounds (Peter Piper picked)
- **Assonance** – repetition of vowel sounds
- Others: hyperbole, onomatopoeia, irony

4. Summary

When reading prose, identify setting, plot, characters, theme and style. Figures of speech make language more vivid and memorable; learn to recognise and use them.

End of Topic 8